

While users today prefer the CD-RW as a storage option, another medium is fast catching up, which has already made an appearance on user desktops. Yes, we mean the DVD. Standalone DVD players made their appearance a long time back, but they were and still are restricted to playing movie DVDs. However, on a computer it attains a different status. You can still play movies on a DVD drive in the computer, but that is not the primary use of the drive. A normal DVD±R/RW can store up to 4.3GB of data, which is almost equal to the amount of hard drive space available on some single hard drives.



An external dual format DVD writer

DVDs make for a viable storage option and reduce clutter as you can store a large amount of data on a single DVD as opposed to storing the same on a number of CDs. This will also prevent you from running from pillar to post when you try to locate your unmarked CDs.

As of now, DVD writers are costlier than CD-RW drives. However, prices are slowly falling, and will probably be in the range of the CD-RW drives available today as soon as HD-DVD and BluRay hit the market.

Another development in DVD technology is the availability of dual-layer media, which can store twice the amount of data on a single side of a single disk (approximately 8.5GB). With the advent